Genes & Proteins

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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DNA Base Sequence To Amino Acid Sequence: Extended

The DNA Base Sequence Determines the Amino Acid Sequence in Protein

- The DNA code (a series of **bases**) is converted into proteins (a series of **amino acids**)
- The process of protein synthesis has two stages
  - **Transcription** (rewriting the base code of DNA into bases of RNA)
  - **Translation** (using RNA base sequence to build amino acids into sequence in a protein)
- Therefore, the sequence of bases in a gene determines the sequence of amino acids that make a specific protein
- Different sequences of amino acids give different shapes and functions to protein molecules

Help me understand

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Students often confuse sequences of **bases** (in DNA/RNA) with sequences of **amino acids** (in proteins).

Make sure you're clear which large molecule you're referring to and therefore, which monomers make up the larger molecule.

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